Stella Li

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Research Interests

Reinforcement Learning, Meta-Cognition, Personalization, Safety & Reliability, Social Reasoning

Education

University of Washington *Sep. 2023 – Current*
Ph.D. in Computer Science
- Advisor: Yulia Tsvetkov

Johns Hopkins University *Sep. 2022 – May 2023*
M.S. in Computer Science
- Advisors: Philipp Koehn & Kenton Murray
- Thesis: Learning from Gibberish: Code-Mixing Data Augmentation for Sentiment Analysis
- Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0

Johns Hopkins University *Sep. 2019 – Dec 2022*
B.A. in Cognitive Science (linguistics focus)
- Additional Majors: Computer Science, Applied Math (statistics focus); Minor: Mathematics
- Cumulative GPA: 3.99/4.0, Major GPA: 4.0/4.0

Select Publications

Verifiable Visual Rewards Transfer from Synthetic Scenes to Natural Prompts
Shuyue Stella Li, Xiaochuang Han, Yulia Tsvetkov, Luke Zettlemoyer. *Preprint 2026.*

ExploreNet: Predictive Exploration Scaling for Diffusion GRPO
Shuyue Stella Li, Xiaochuang Han, Yulia Tsvetkov, Luke Zettlemoyer. *Preprint 2026.*

IsoVGRBench: Video Reward Modeling Without Human Feedback
Shuyue Stella Li, Jacqueline He, Jiahui Chen, Sreya Dutta Roy, Yulia Tsvetkov, Luke Zettlemoyer, Marjan Ghazvininejad, Xiaochuang Han. *Preprint 2026.*

Cognitive Foundations for Reasoning and Their Manifestation in LLMs
Priyanka Kargupta*, Shuyue Stella Li*, Haocheng Wang, Jinu Lee, Dean Light, Shan Chen, Orevaoghene Ahia, Tom Griffiths, Max Kleiman-Weiner, Jiawei Han, Asli Celikyilmaz, Yulia Tsvetkov. *Preprint 2026.*

HorizonBench: Long-Horizon Personalization with Evolving Preferences
Shuyue Stella Li, Bhargavi Paranjape, Kerem Oktar, Zhongyao Ma, Gelin Zhou, Lin Guan, Na Zhang, Sem Park, Lin Chen, Diyi Yang, Yulia Tsvetkov, Asli Celikyilmaz. *Preprint 2026.*

EvoLM: Self-Evolving Language Models through Co-Evolved Discriminative Rubrics
Shuyue Stella Li*, Rui Xin*, Yike Wang, Yike Wang, Teng Xiao, Rulin Shao, Zoey Hao, Melanie Sclar, Faeze Brahman, Pang Wei Koh, Yulia Tsvetkov. *Preprint 2026.*

Fighting Fire with Fire: Assessing Test Set Contamination Via Deliberate Training on Test Data
Melanie Sclar*, Shuyue Stella Li*, Niloofar Mireshghallah, Yejin Choi, Yulia Tsvetkov. *Preprint 2026.*

Ads in AI Chatbots? An Analysis of How Large Language Models Navigate Conflicts of Interest
Addison J Wu*, Ryan Liu*, Shuyue Stella Li, Yulia Tsvetkov, Thomas L Griffiths. *COLM 2026.*

Cold-Start Personalization via Training-Free Priors from Structured World Models
Avinandan Bose*, Shuyue Stella Li*, Faeze Brahman, Pang Wei Koh, Simon Shaolei Du, Yulia Tsvetkov, Maryam Fazel, Lin Xiao, Asli Celikyilmaz. *In Proceedings of ICML 2026.*

Personalized Reasoning: Just-In-Time Personalization and Why LLMs Fail At It
Shuyue Stella Li*, Avinandan Bose*, Faeze Brahman, Simon Shaolei Du, Pang Wei Koh, Maryam Fazel, Yulia Tsvetkov. *In Proceedings of ICLR 2026.*

OLMo 3
Team Olmo, . . . , Shuyue Stella Li, et al. *Technical Report 2025.*

Spurious Rewards: Rethinking training signals in RLVR
Rulin Shao*, Shuyue Stella Li*, Rui Xin*, Scott Geng*, Yiping Wang, Sewoong Oh, Simon Shaolei Du, Nathan Lambert, Sewon Min, Ranjay Krishna, Yulia Tsvetkov, Hannaneh Hajishirzi, Pang Wei Koh, Luke Zettlemoyer. *In Proceedings of ICML 2026.*

ALFA: Aligning llms to ask good questions a case study in clinical reasoning
Shuyue Stella Li*, Jimin Mun*, Pedram Hosseini, Bryceton G. Thomas, Jessica M. Sin, Bing Ren, Jonathan S. Ilgen, Yulia Tsvetkov, Maarten Sap. *In Proceedings of COLM 2025.*

PrefPalette: Personalized preference modeling with latent attributes
Shuyue Stella Li, Melanie Sclar, Hunter Lang, Ansong Ni, Jacqueline He, Puxin Xu, Andrew Cohen, Chan Young Park, Yulia Tsvetkov, Asli Celikyilmaz. *In Proceedings of COLM 2025. Spotlight Paper.*

MediQ: Question-asking LLMs and a benchmark for reliable interactive clinical reasoning
Shuyue Stella Li, Vidhisha Balachandran, Shangbin Feng, Jonathan S Ilgen, Emma Pierson, Pang Wei Koh, Yulia Tsvetkov. *In Proceedings of Neurips 2024.*

Valuescope: Unveiling implicit norms and values via return potential model of social interactions
Chan Young Park*, Shuyue Stella Li*, Hayoung Jung*, Svitlana Volkova, Tanushree Mitra, David Jurgens, Yulia Tsvetkov. *In Proceedings of EMNLP 2024.*

Teaching Experience

Ethics in AI (CSE 582) — *University of Washington*
Teaching Assistant — *Jan. 2025 – March 2025*

Introduction to Statistics (EN.553.430) — *Johns Hopkins University*
Teaching Assistant — *Sep. 2021 – May 2023*

Human-Computer Interaction (EN.601.490) — *Johns Hopkins University*
Course Assistant — *Sep. 2022 – Dec. 2022*

Computer Ethics (EN.601.104) — *Johns Hopkins University*
Head Course Assistant — *May 2022 – Aug. 2022*

Intermediate Programming (EN.601.220) — *Johns Hopkins University*
Course Assistant — *Sep. 2021 – May 2022*

Mentoring

Mohammadamin Shafiei, M.S., University of Milan — *Sep. 2025 – July 2026*
- Sole mentor; LLM bias behind logical puzzles; outcome: EMNLP 2026 paper. COLM Workshop Oral.

Jack Zhang, Undergraduate, UW — *Feb. 2025 – July 2026*
- Mentored end-to-end on mid-training influence. Spotlight paper at COLM Workshop for Efficient Reasoning.

Arnav Mazumder, Undergraduate, UW — *Feb. 2025 – July 2026*
- Mentored with another PhD student; contextual machine translation; WMT 2026 paper.

Work Experience

Visiting Researcher — *Seattle, WA*
Meta FAIR — *Sep. 2024 – Current*
- Visiting researcher at FAIR working on social reasoning & alignment projects.

Research Intern — *East Lansing, MI*
MSU Genetic Programming Lab — *May 2021 – Aug 2021*
- Advised by Dr. Wolfgang Banzhaf; outcome: 2 research publications, 1 open-source software.
- Designed and implemented novel GP algorithm for LLVM compiler flag optimization (20%).

Research Intern — *Baltimore, MD*

JHU Language & Cognition Lab *Jan 2019 – May 2021*

- Advised by Dr. Barbara Landau, studying developmental spatial cognition through block building.
- Designed experiments, collected eye-tracking data from 50+ participants, developed coding scheme and analysis pipeline for the collected data.

Honors & Awards

Qualcomm Fellowship Finalist *2026*
Jane Street Fellowship Honorable Mention *2026*
IEEE Rising Stars 2026 *2026*
COLM Spotlight Paper Award (24/418 papers) *2025*
JHU Responsible AI for Health Student Travel Grant *2024*
Weil Family Endowed Fellowship in Computer Science & Engineering *2023-24*
Johns Hopkins Dean's List *2019-23*
Upsilon Pi Epsilon Computer Science Honor Society *2022*
GECCO-GI Best Presentation Award *2022*
ACM Student Travel Grant *2022*
PAJH Greek Scholars Award *2022*
Grace Hopper Scholarship Award *2022*
Omicron Delta Kappa National Leadership Honors Society *2022*
Omega Psi National Cognitive Science Honors Society *2022*
Cum Laude Society *2022*

Service

Reviewer: ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, NeurIPS, ICLR, AISTATS, COLM

Skills

Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, R, MATLAB, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, ReactJS, Go